

# Drawing Tools and Annotations

Charts & Workspace | beginner | 5 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

Drawings — lines, levels, rectangles, Fibonacci tools, text notes — are how you mark up a DeepCharts chart. Every tool is available from two places: the left toolbar strip on the chart and the right-click menu under **Drawing Objects**, most with a keyboard shortcut.

This article lists every drawing object and its hotkey, then covers the workflows around drawings: editing and reusing styles, snapping, hiding, bulk-erasing, moving annotations between charts and machines, and keeping drawings in sync across charts of the same instrument.

## What it is

The annotation system of the chart window. It answers "how do I draw X", "how do I change a drawing's color", "where did my drawings go", and "how do I get my drawings onto another chart or another PC".

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] A chart with several annotations placed — a horizontal line at a level, a trend line, a rectangle zone and a text note — with the left drawing toolbar strip visible and the right-click Drawing Objects submenu open dc-en-drawing-tools-01.png

## When to use it

- Mark support/resistance levels, zones, and session extremes.
- Measure moves and plan trades (Ruler, Buy/Sell calculator).
- Annotate charts for a journal or to share as screenshots.
- Keep the same levels visible across several charts of one instrument.

## Quick start

1. Right-click the chart and open **Drawing Objects**, or use the left toolbar strip (toggle it with the ≡ icon at the top left).
2. Pick a tool — for example **Horizontal Line** (Shift H) — and click on the chart to place it.
3. To edit a drawing, double left-click it (or left-click to select, then right-click → **Settings**) and change colors and styles in the Annotation Settings.
4. To remove one drawing, select it and delete it; to clear everything, use right-click → **Drawing Utilities** → **Erase All Drawing** (see the warning below).

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] The Annotation Settings dialog open for a horizontal line, showing color, line style and width options dc-en-drawing-tools-02.png

## Settings reference

### Drawing Objects (right-click → Drawing Objects)

| Tool (hotkey)                    | What it does                                         |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Horizontal Line</b> (Shift H) | Price level across the chart.                        |
| <b>Vertical Line</b>             | Marks a point in time.                               |
| <b>Horizontal Ray</b>            | Price level starting at a point and extending right. |
| <b>Line</b> (Shift L)            | Free trend line between two points.                  |
| <b>Parallel Lines</b> (Shift P)  | Parallel channel.                                    |
| <b>Ruler</b>                     | Measures between two chart points.                   |

| Tool (hotkey)                      | What it does                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rectangle</b> (Shift R)         | Price/time zone. If it stops responding, see Fix: Rectangle Drawing Tool Not Working.                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Ellipse</b>                     | Elliptical zone.                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Text</b> (Shift T)              | Text note on the chart.                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Pencil</b>                      | Freehand drawing.                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Price Retracement</b> (Shift F) | Fibonacci retracement.                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Price Projection</b>            | Fibonacci projection.                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Price Fan</b>                   | Fan tool — corresponds to the Fibonacci fan listed in <b>Options</b> → <b>Settings</b> → <b>Toolbar</b> .                                                                                                        |
| <b>Volume Profile</b> (Shift V)    | Draws a volume profile over a selected range. Concept: Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN.                                                                                                   |
| <b>VWAP</b>                        | VWAP drawing tool. Concept: Understanding VWAP.                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Buy calculator</b> (Shift B)    | Position calculator for longs: place it, then drag the stop-loss area and the take-profit area up or down — it shows the risk/reward ratio, the price of both levels, and each level's tick distance from entry. |
| <b>Sell calculator</b> (Shift S)   | The same position calculator for shorts.                                                                                                                                                                         |

[ SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER ] A Buy calculator drawing placed on a chart with the SL area below entry and TP area above, showing the risk/reward ratio and tick distances [dc-en-drawing-tools-03.png](#)

**Tip:** The cursor-mode entries in the same right-click menu are worth memorizing: **Pointer** (Alt P), **Crosshair** (Alt C), **Global Crosshair** (Alt G — crosshair on all charts of the same instrument), **Hand** (Alt H). Hotkeys are configurable — see How to Configure Keyboard Shortcuts.

### Left toolbar extras

The left strip mirrors the drawing tools (which tools appear there is configurable in **Options** → **Settings** → **Toolbar**), plus:

| Icon          | What it does                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Eye</b>    | Hides/shows ALL drawings on the chart.                                                                                                         |
| <b>Magnet</b> | When enabled, new drawings attach to the closest main level — the nearest candle wick high/low or open/close. Disabled = fully free placement. |
| <b>Eraser</b> | Removes drawings.                                                                                                                              |

### Editing and reusing styles

- **Edit:** double left-click a drawing, or select it and right-click → **Settings**.
- **Save a configuration:** store a drawing's style settings for future reuse from its settings dialog.
- **Recall a configuration:** right-click the drawing and open **Tool Config**.

### Drawing Utilities (right-click → Drawing Utilities)

| Item                      | What it does                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Import Annotations</b> | Loads drawings from a file.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Export Annotations</b> | Saves drawings to a file — format selectable: CSV or the Volumetrica format (specific to the DeepCharts apps). This is how you move drawings between machines or share them.<br><b>[CONFIRM: whether export covers all drawings or only selected ones]</b> |

| Item                            | What it does                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Snap annotation</b> (Ctrl S) | Snapping toggle for annotations <b>[CONFIRM: whether this is the same toggle as the magnet icon]</b> . |
| <b>Hide/Show annotations</b>    | Toggles visibility of annotations on the chart.                                                        |
| <b>Erase All Drawing</b>        | Removes every drawing from the chart.                                                                  |

**Warning: Erase All Drawing** deletes all drawings on the chart in one action. Export your annotations first if there is any chance you will want them back.

### ***Drawings across charts***

- **Drawing Tool From Other Chart** (right-click menu) syncs drawings between charts — set it between, say, a 1-minute and a 5-minute chart of the same symbol, and a drawing made on one appears on the other.
- To carry a full chart setup (drawings context included) to another chart or PC, use templates and workspaces — see Templates and Workspaces.

### **Tips and common mistakes**

- **"My drawings disappeared."** Before assuming they are lost, check the **eye** icon on the left toolbar and right-click → **Drawing Utilities** → **Hide/Show annotations** — one of the two visibility toggles is usually the cause.
- **Drawings won't land exactly on candle highs/lows** — enable the **magnet** icon so new drawings snap to the nearest wick or open/close.
- **Moving to a new PC?** Right-click → **Drawing Utilities** → **Export Annotations**, copy the file over, then **Import Annotations** on the other machine.
- **Plan the trade before placing it:** the **Buy/Sell calculator** shows risk/reward and tick distances while you drag the levels — faster than computing them by hand.
- Related chart-level options: **Options** → **Settings** → **General** → **Chart** includes annotation behaviors such as **Editable copied annotation** and **Annotations stop on last bar**.

### **Related articles**

- The Chart Window
- Fix: Rectangle Drawing Tool Not Working
- Keyboard Shortcuts Reference
- Templates and Workspaces
- Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN
- Understanding VWAP